Plans and memory

AI agents · University · Lesson 1



In this lesson you will

- Compare planning first with planning step by step.
- Explain why errors carry forward, and where to check.
- Budget a context window and choose what stays.

Key ideas

- Each step builds on the last: check every result before using it.
- The context window is the only memory: 384 tokens for Darsi Tiny, about 128,000 for big models.
- The app decides what stays: recent turns, notes, pinned facts, retrieval.

Activity: The ten-note window

1. Set-up (3 min): Ten sticky notes are the window.
2. Plan (6 min): Plan a trip, one note per turn.
3. Overflow (6 min): Out of notes? Drop or summarise.
4. Test (5 min): Ask about day one. What survived?

Any made-up trip will do. If you have no sticky notes, use ten small squares of paper and a desk.

Let’s discuss

1. When is planning first better than step by step, and when is it worse?
2. Why can’t a model tell you what it has forgotten?
3. What would you pin at the top of an agent’s window for your own studies?

Exit ticket

- One check an agent needs after every step, and one fact you would pin in its window.